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impulsivity. People with Tourette's have also reported problems with depression or anxiety disorders, as well as other difficulties Tourette's syndrome may or may not directly cause. Tourette's is a diagnosis doctors make after verifying that the patient has had both motor and vocal

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tics for at least one year. The existence of other neurological or psychiatric conditions can also help doctors establish the diagnosis of Tourette's is the correct one. Knowledgeable clinicians consulted by patients do not often misdiagnose common tics. However, atypical

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symptoms or atypical presentation, such as onset of symptoms in adulthood, may require specialty expertise for diagnosis. There are no blood or laboratory tests needed for diagnosis. However, neuroimaging studies, which include magnetic resonance imaging, computerized

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tomography, and electroencephalograms, as well as certain lab tests, may be used to rule out other conditions that Tourette's might be confused with. In terms of the role of genes in the disorder, evidence from twin and family studies suggests that Tourette's is an inherited disorder. Although

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early family studies suggested an autosomal dominant mode of inheritance characterized the condition, more recent studies discovered the pattern of inheritance was much more complex. Although there may be a few genes that have substantial effects, it's also possible that many genes with smaller effects and environmental factors may

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play a role in the development of Tourette's. Genetic studies also suggest that some forms of Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder and Obsessive Compulsive Disorder are genetically related to Tourette's, but there is less evidence for a genetic relationship between Tourette's

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and other neurobehavioral problems that Tourette's commonly co-occurs with. An important role in Tourette's gene expression is played by the sex of the person. In particular, males affected by the gene are more likely to have tics, and females who have a genetic predisposition are more likely

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to have obsessive-compulsive symptoms. Much current research is aimed at better understanding the genetic basis and symptomatology of Tourette's, as well as its relationship to related disorders. The hope is that this research leads to better diagnostic tools and better

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treatments for Tourette's.

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